



Discussion Guide: Robert Wright

The Leadership that Love Demands

Reflect

- Who is the most effective leader you have ever personally encountered? What made them effective and how did they positively impact you?
- Robert offers two different definitions of leadership: “the capacity to mobilize people to address tough problems, especially tough problems they would rather avoid” and “a delivery system for love.” Which of these definitions of leadership do you prefer and why?
- Robert says that to lead we need to work on three capacities: 1) diagnosing situations; 2) self-management; 3) energizing others. Which of these capacities comes most naturally to you? Which do you value and desire most from leaders in your own faith community?

Respond

- To what extent do you think Christian leadership should look different from leadership in other contexts (business, sports, education, etc.)? Where is there overlap? Where do they (or should they) diverge?
- Jesus was able to energize people in part because he was clear about his purpose. How would you describe the purpose of your own church or faith community? How does this purpose align (or not align) with what you sense to be your own purpose as a disciple of Christ?